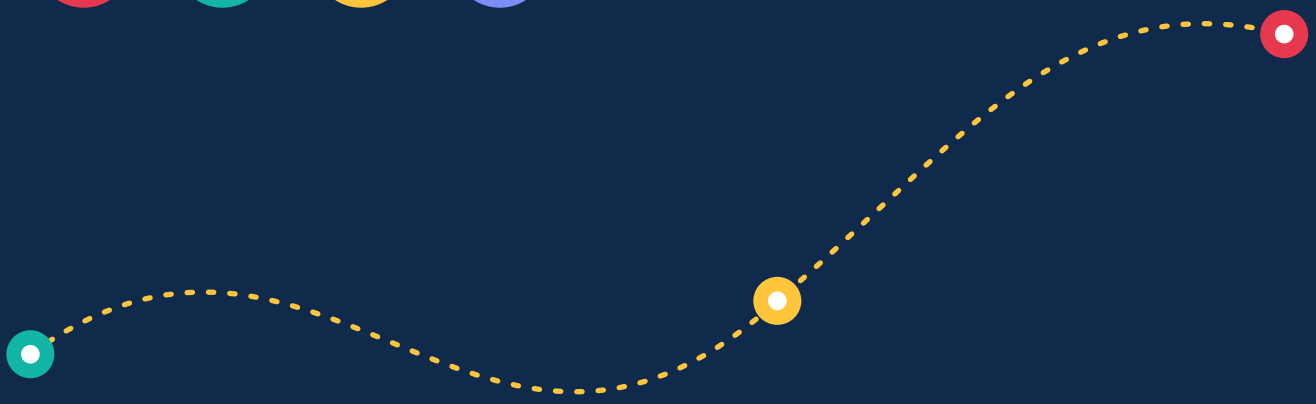
PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES

NATIONAL BUSINESS | BD

Pathao

Super-App Growth & Paid Social Strategy: winning customers and partners on both sides of the marketplace





BUSINESS RESEARCHED	Pathao (ride, food, parcel and payments super-app) — Bangladesh
RESEARCH TOPIC	How can Pathao grow profitable usage and cross-sell across services using paid social, while recruiting reliable partners?
PREPARED BY	Shakir Hossain Talha
ROLE	Digital Marketing Manager | Social Media Marketing Strategist
RESEARCH DATE	03 March 2025

Independent strategic research based on publicly observable brand activity. Not affiliated with or commissioned by the brand.

Executive Summary

THE CHALLENGE

Pathao must win two audiences at once: customers who want safe, reliable, fairly priced daily services, and partners (riders, merchants, SMEs) who need steady earnings. Paid social has to speak to both with different messages and proof.

THE OPPORTUNITY

A super-app can cross-sell: a ride or food user is the cheapest route to a courier or payment user. Traffic, time pressure and mobile-first habits make convenience a strong emotional trigger in Bangladesh.

THE APPROACH

Separate funnels per audience, trust-first creative (safety, speed, price clarity), cross-sell sequencing, and measurement from install to repeat usage, not just cheap installs.

QUESTIONS THIS CASE STUDY ANSWERS

1. Who are the real customers and partners, and what makes each of them act?
2. Where does Pathao face the toughest competition and where is the white space?
3. Which message and proof builds trust fastest in a safety-sensitive category?
4. How should the Meta Ads funnel differ for riders, food users and SME sellers?
5. What should be measured so growth is profitable, not just loud?

4 services analysed	**4** audience segments	**6** step activation path	**90** day action roadmap

METHOD & NOTE ON DATA

Desk research of public social profiles, ad library activity, app store positioning, news and customer commentary. Scores and KPI figures are analyst assessments and planning benchmarks to be validated, not company data.

Business Snapshot

Pathao started in Dhaka in 2015 as a motorbike ride-sharing service and grew into a multi-service platform. Its strength is daily-life utility; its challenge is that each service has a different customer and competitor.

RIDES

Bike and car rides for commuting. Core habit builder; safety and availability decide trust.

FOOD

Restaurant delivery. High frequency; depends on merchant range, speed and promo fairness.

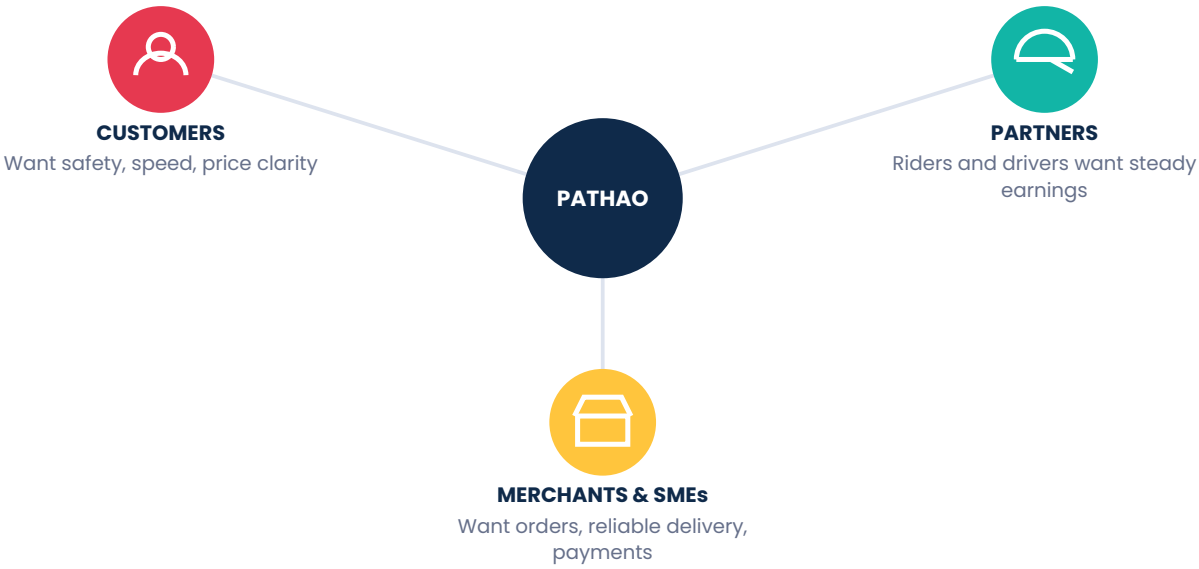
PARCEL / COURIER

Delivery for SMEs and social sellers. Reliability and cash-on-delivery handling are key.

PAY

Digital wallet and payments. Trust and everyday usefulness drive adoption.

ECOSYSTEM: THREE SIDES TO SERVE



MARKETING IMPLICATION

Every service has two sides that must grow together. Paid social should never run one generic 'download the app' message: customers, merchants and partners each need their own promise, proof and call to action.

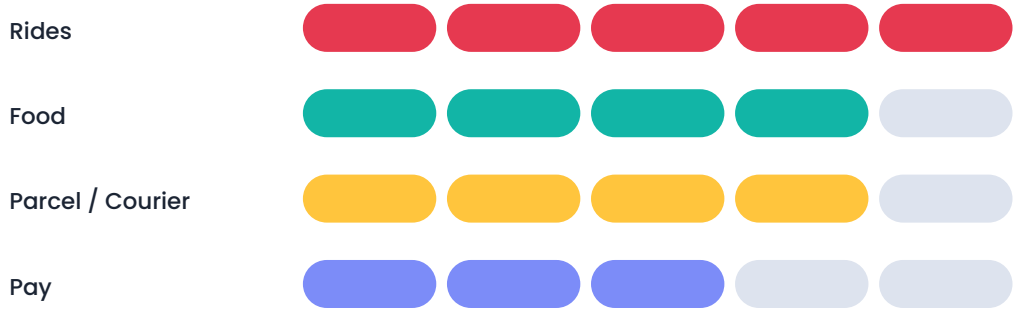
Competitor Landscape

Pathao competes in four different battles. The messaging, offer and audience must change service by service.

SERVICE	KEY COMPETITORS	THEIR EDGE	PATHAO COUNTER
Rides	Uber, Obhai, Shohoz and others	Availability, fare clarity, driver quality	Safety features and local trust
Food	Foodpanda, restaurant-owned channels	Restaurant range, promos, delivery time	Frequency habit + cross-app wallet
Parcel / Courier	Steadfast, RedX, Paperfly and others	Merchant tools, COD handling, coverage	SME onboarding + tracking transparency
Pay	Mobile wallets and banking apps	Trust, cash-in/out reach, merchant acceptance	In-app usefulness across services

COMPETITIVE INTENSITY BY SERVICE

Analyst assessment, 1 (low) to 5 (very high). To be validated with live market data.



THE WHITE SPACE

Nobody owns 'the everyday app that handles the whole day': get to work, order dinner, send a parcel, pay for it. Pathao's cross-service position is hard for single-service rivals to copy, and paid social should sell that convenience story.

HOW TO RESPOND TO COMPETITOR MOVES

Rival cuts prices

Compete on trust and reliability proof, not a race to the bottom.

Rival runs big promos

Use loyalty and bundled value; measure repeat after promo ends.

Single-service specialist

Show cross-service convenience they cannot match.

Who Uses It & Why

THE DAILY COMMUTER

Job: reach work or class on time.

Trigger: traffic stress, running late.

Barrier: safety and fare uncertainty.

Message: Get there on time, with confidence.

THE HOME-DELIVERY USER

Job: eat well without losing time.

Trigger: hunger, weather, busy evenings.

Barrier: late orders, unclear promos.

Message: Great food, handled for you.

THE SME / SOCIAL SELLER

Job: deliver orders and get paid.

Trigger: growing order volume.

Barrier: lost parcels, COD risk.

Message: Deliver with confidence, track every parcel.

THE PARTNER (RIDER)

Job: earn steadily on flexible hours.

Trigger: need for income stability.

Barrier: unclear earnings, support gaps.

Message: Earn on your own schedule, with support.

WHAT USERS WEIGH MOST (hypothesis, to validate)



Positioning & Messaging

POSITIONING STATEMENT

For busy people in Bangladesh, Pathao is the everyday super-app that gets you moving, fed and delivered with local trust, so the day runs smoother.

MESSAGE MATRIX BY AUDIENCE

AUDIENCE	CORE MESSAGE	PROOF ASSET	CTA
Commuters	Get there on time, with confidence.	Live trip tracking, safety feature demos	Book a ride
Food users	Great food, handled for you.	Restaurant range, order tracking clips	Order now
SMEs & sellers	Deliver with confidence.	Seller stories, parcel tracking walkthrough	Start sending
Partners	Earn on your own schedule.	Onboarding steps, support explainers	Join as partner

BRAND TRUST PRINCIPLES

SHOW SAFETY
Make safety features visible in every ride creative.

BE PRICE-CLEAR
No hidden fees; show how fare or offer works.

USE LOCAL VOICE
Bangla-first, relatable Dhaka and city moments.

PROVE, DON'T CLAIM
Real trips, real sellers, real partner stories.

Campaign line idea: "Your whole day, one app."

SAMPLE AD HOOKS (first 3 seconds)

RIDE Running late? Your ride is a few taps away.

FOOD Rain outside. Dinner on the way.

PARCEL Every parcel tracked. Every customer updated.

PARTNER Your hours. Your earnings. Your call.

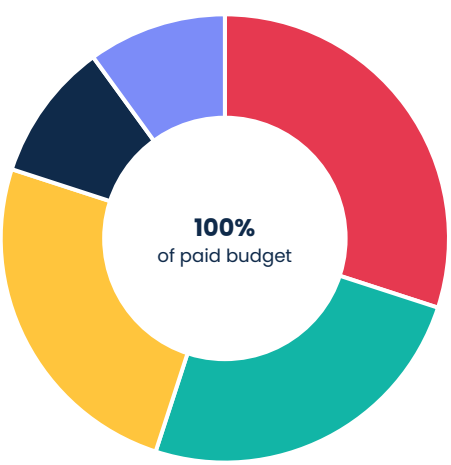
Meta Ads Funnel & Budget

ACTIVATION PATH (what we optimise for)



AUDIENCE	OBJECTIVE	TARGETING	CREATIVE	KEY COST METRIC
Commuters	Install / App events	City + interest + lookalike of first-ride users	Short ride-safety and convenience reels	Cost per first ride
Food users	App events (orders)	Urban 18–40, evening-heavy schedule	Meal moments, merchant spotlights	Cost per first order
SMEs / sellers	Leads / Messages	Page owners, F-commerce sellers, small shops	Seller testimonials, tracking demos	Cost per onboarded seller
Partners	Leads	Job seekers, riders, drivers by city	Earning flexibility, onboarding steps	Cost per activated partner

SUGGESTED BUDGET SPLIT (planning)



Rides	30%
Food	25%
SME courier	25%
Partner recruitment	10%
Retention / cross-sell	10%

RULE OF THE FUNNEL

Judge campaigns by activated users and repeat usage, not cheap installs alone. An install that never orders is a cost, not growth.

KPIs & 90-Day Roadmap

INSTALL QUALITY
Install > register > first order rate

ACTIVATION
Cost per activated user

RETENTION
14-day and 30-day repeat rate

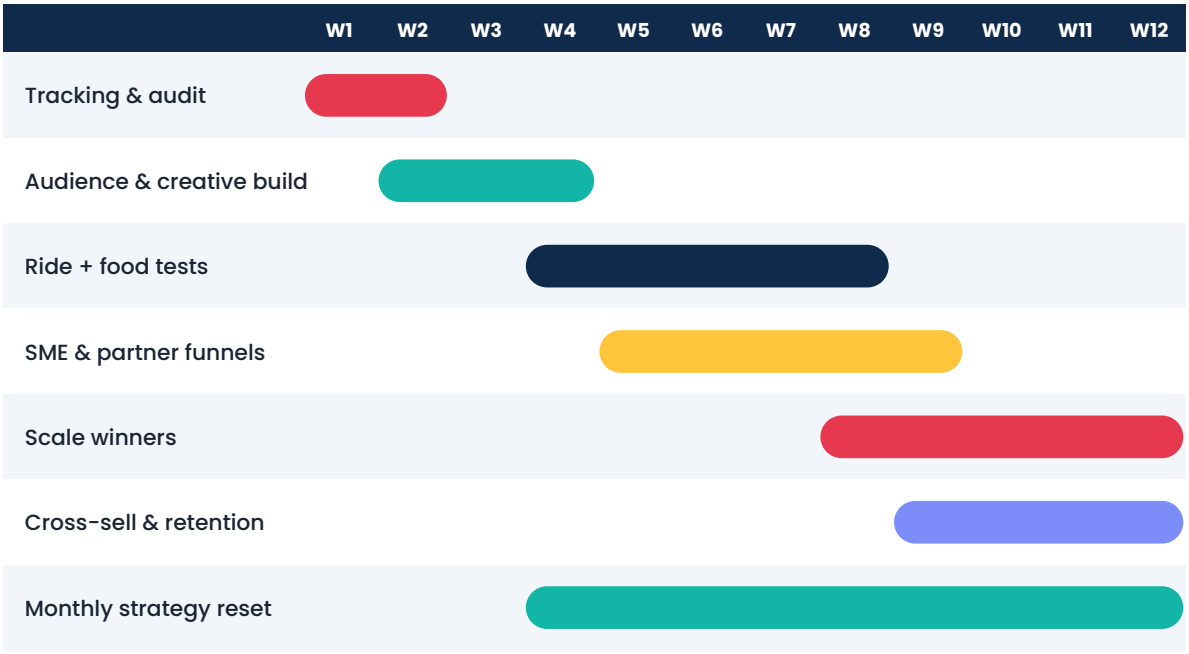
CROSS-SELL
Share of users on 2+ services

PARTNER SUPPLY
Cost per activated partner

EFFICIENCY
CPA vs. contribution margin, ROAS

Targets are set per city and service after a 2-week learning phase. Benchmarks are assumptions, not company data.

90-DAY ROADMAP BY WORKSTREAM



KEY RISKS & HOW TO MANAGE THEM

Ad costs rise in peak periods
Plan creative refresh and budget shifts before peaks.

Promo dependence
Test value-led offers and measure repeat after promo ends.

Trust incidents
Keep safety proof and support messaging ready for fast response.

PREPARED BY

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WHAT THIS CASE STUDY SHOWS

How I work: research the market, decode customer psychology, sharpen positioning, then build a paid social funnel that is measured on real business outcomes. Strategy first, data always, growth you can see.

Market Research | Customer Psychology | Positioning | Meta Ads

Shakir

SIGNATURE

Shakir Hossain Talha
Digital Marketing Manager

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